

Key Loggers

Key loggers are programs that run transparently on your computer and keep track of every single keystroke from your keyboard. These tools are freely available and can reveal everything you type, including passwords, to anyone who knows that such a program is running on your machine. Usually, these software also regularly send out the logs to the e-mail address of the person who installed it. Most anti-virus software are geared to trap and prevent key loggers.



bring up a list of suspicious files from your hard disk. Not surprisingly, there are also software such as PeaceFire (www.peacefire.org) available for free, that block out many popular parental control software.

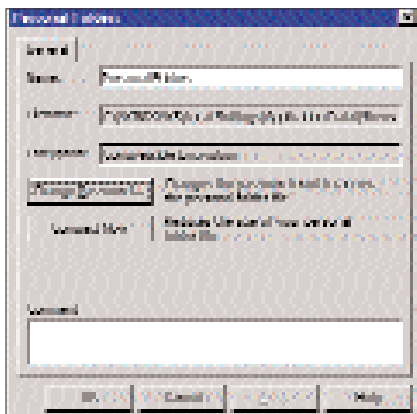
Outlook Express identities

Outlook Express has grown to be one of the most popular e-mail clients because of its integration with Internet Explorer, ease of use and features such as support for multiple identities. It is quite complete as a basic e-mail client, but security of e-mail is quite flawed. On the face of it, you can assign passwords to each identity so that each user can maintain his or her accounts, settings and e-mail. This feature has multiple flaws and working around it to access another person's e-mail is quite simple.

First of all, after a user logs in to an identity, it is necessary to log off, otherwise the client promptly opens up with the same identity. Simply closing the application is of no use. Secondly, if a person wants to access your e-mail, he or she can simply create a new identity and point his store

folder to the existing mailbox folder from **Tools > Options > Maintenance**. Another way to get to the mail is to copy off the mailbox files to another PC. Account settings are easily accessible for pranksters with a little knowledge of Windows, from the Windows Registry.

The identity feature works just like the Windows logon—it acts as a profile login to load



Set a password for the mailbox file in Outlook

your settings and that's it. For e-mail security, you should switch to Outlook, which is bundled with MS Office. Here, the mailbox file itself is password-protected, so there is no easy way of accessing your messages. One would have to actually crack the code. Outlook will ask for a password every time it is opened, and the same password will be applicable even if the file is copied to another machine and loaded in a different Outlook. The password will be required even when importing messages from the mailbox. You can set the password from **Tools > Options > Mail Setup > Data Files > Settings**.

It is possible to overcome most security flaws in Windows systems. Though some of them are not the most elegant solutions, they will definitely keep most prying eyes away. Plus, they do save you big bucks in upgrading the operating system and the hardware to match it. Now you can sleep peacefully.

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